

Physical Chemistry (I)

Lecture 03

Kinetic Molecular Theory



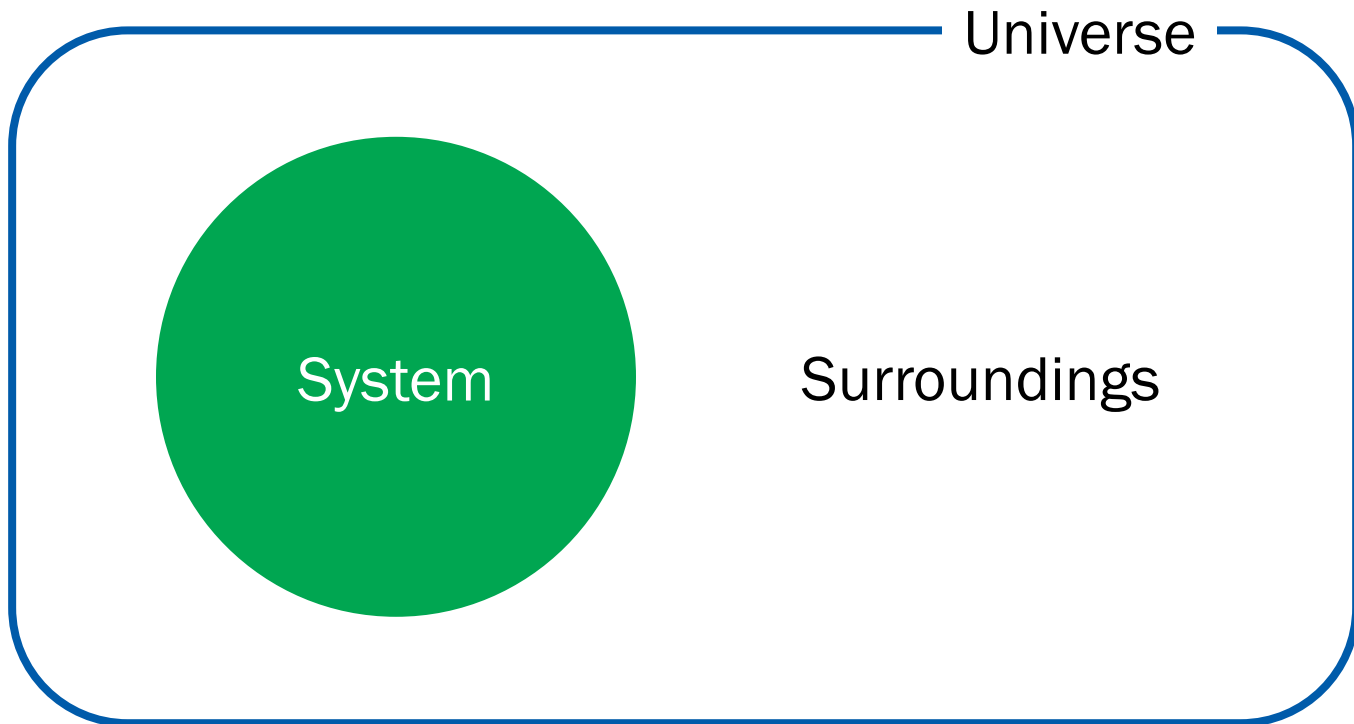
In the Last Class

- Basic Concepts
 - System: properties, equilibrium
 - System state and state change
- Gases
 - Why gases?
 - Perfect gas
 - Kinetic molecular theory



Last Class

System and Surroundings



System Properties

- A system can have different **physical properties**
- A **single value** will be assigned for each property
- Useful classification
 - **Extensive properties:** $f(A) + f(B) = f(A + B)$
 - **Intensive properties:** $f(A) + f(B) \neq f(A + B)$

Equilibrium

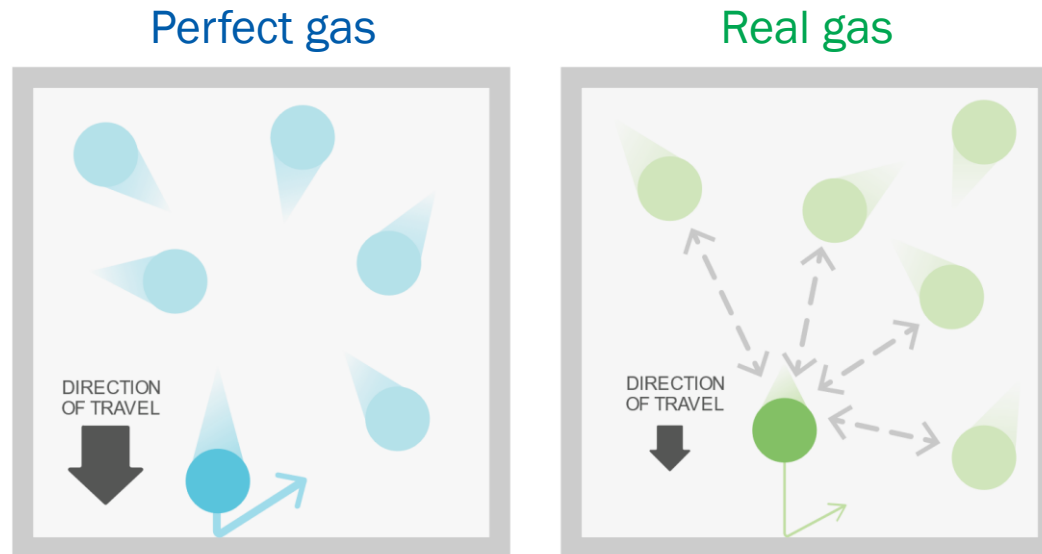
- An isolated system is **in equilibrium** when its properties remain **constant with time**
- Mechanical equilibrium: constant p and V
- Diffusive equilibrium: constant n
- Thermal equilibrium: constant T

State of a System

- The **state** of a system is defined by its **properties**
- For a pure substance: (n, V, p, T)
- **State change:** $(n_1, V_1, p_1, T_1) \rightarrow (n_2, V_2, p_2, T_2)$

Perfect Gas

- Perfect gas (ideal gas): no interactions
- Real gas: finite interactions between molecules



(Image: <https://cdn.kastatic.org/ka-perseus-images/4d1bf2d46543cc34f4948085bb9196f5dfb57515.svg>)

Equation of State

- The state of a pure gas is defined by (n, V, p, T)
- **Equation of state:** relationship of the 4 variables

$$p = f(T, V, n)$$

- Equation of state of a perfect gas: **perfect gas law**

$$p = nRT/V$$

↑
gas constant

Kinetic Molecular Theory

Total energy = Σ (kinetic energies of molecules)

1. Molecules with mass m in ceaseless random motion
2. Molecules with negligible size
3. Elastic collisions: the total kinetic energy is conserved

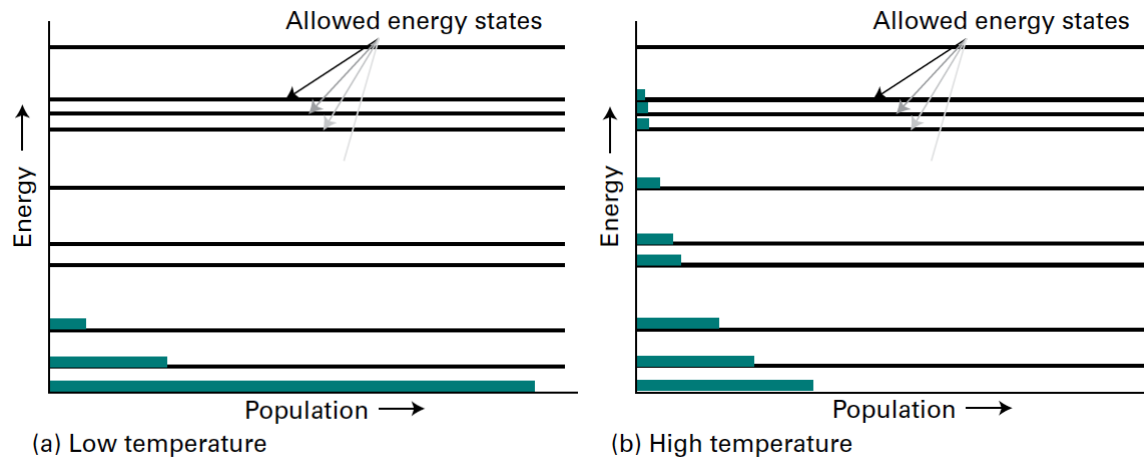
Boltzmann Distribution

Boltzmann constant



$$\text{Probability} \propto e^{-E/k_B T}$$

(at thermal equilibrium)



Boltzmann Distribution

- Probability density for energy E

$$f(E) \propto e^{-E/k_{\text{B}}T}$$

$$f(E) = K e^{-E/k_{\text{B}}T}$$

- $f(E)dE$: the probability that a molecule has an energy in the range $[E, E + dE]$

Velocity Distribution

$$f(E) = K e^{-E/k_B T}$$

$$\text{As } E = mv^2/2 = mv_x^2/2 + mv_y^2/2 + mv_z^2/2,$$

$$f(v_x, v_y, v_z) = K e^{-mv_x^2/2k_B T} e^{-mv_y^2/2k_B T} e^{-mv_z^2/2k_B T}$$

After normalization,

$$f(v_x, v_y, v_z) = \left(\frac{m}{2\pi k_B T} \right)^{3/2} e^{-m(v_x^2 + v_y^2 + v_z^2)/2k_B T}$$

Velocity to Speed

- $f(v_x, v_y, v_z)dv_x dv_y dv_z$:

Probability that a molecule has a velocity in the range

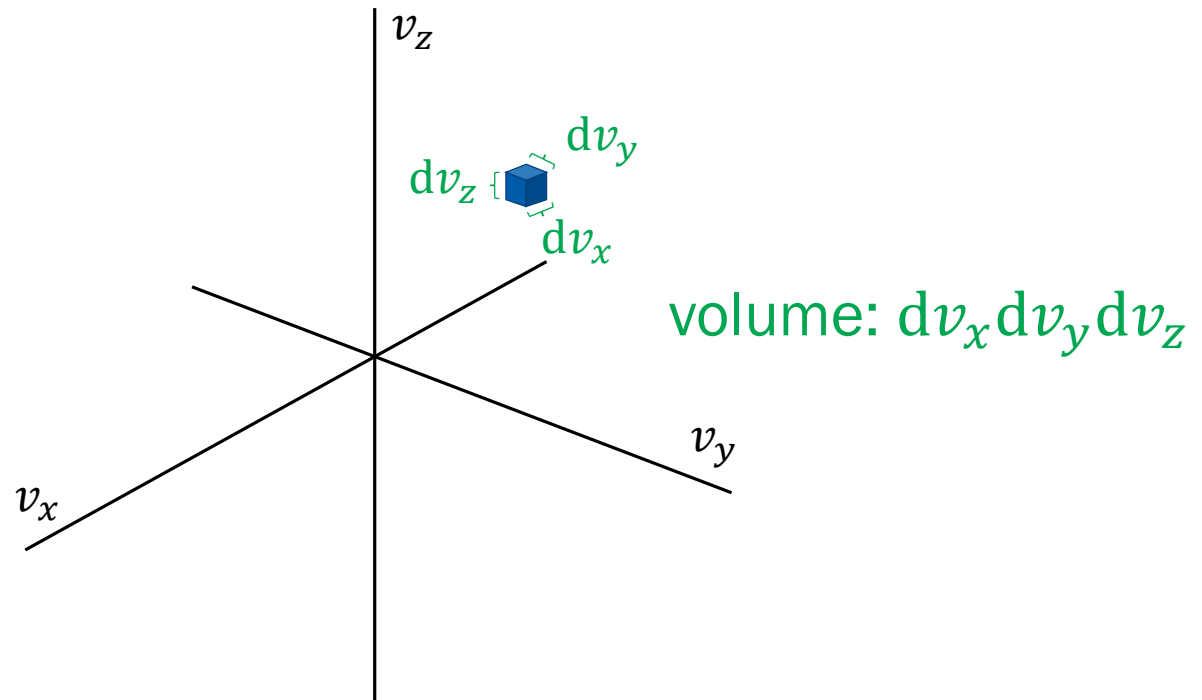
$$[v_x, v_x + dv_x], [v_y, v_y + dv_y], [v_z, v_z + dv_z]$$

- $f(v)dv$:

Probability that a molecule has a speed in the range $[v, v + dv]$

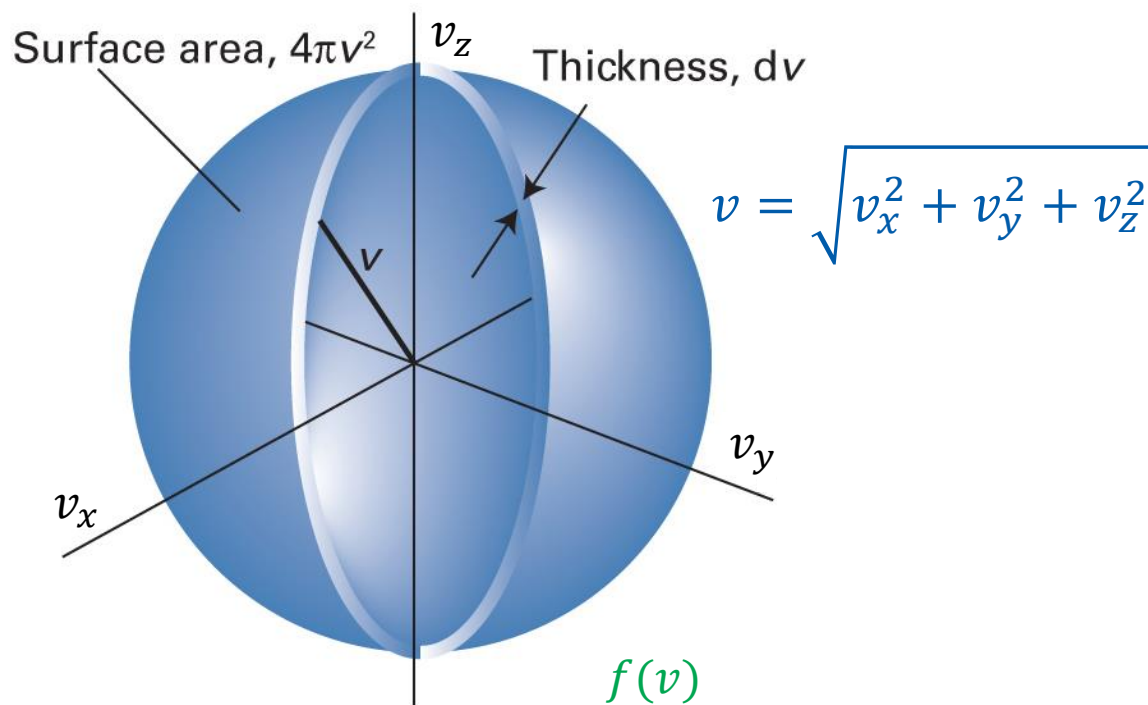
Can we obtain $f(v)dv$ from $f(v_x, v_y, v_z)dv_x dv_y dv_z$?

Velocity Space



$$f(v_x, v_y, v_z) dv_x dv_y dv_z = \text{function} \times \text{volume}$$

Velocity Space



function $\times$ volume = $f(v_x, v_y, v_z) \times 4\pi v^2 dv$

Maxwell-Boltzmann Distribution

$$f(v) = f(v_x, v_y, v_z) 4\pi v^2$$

$$f(v) = 4\pi \left(\frac{m}{2\pi k_B T} \right)^{3/2} v^2 e^{-m(v_x^2 + v_y^2 + v_z^2)/2k_B T}$$

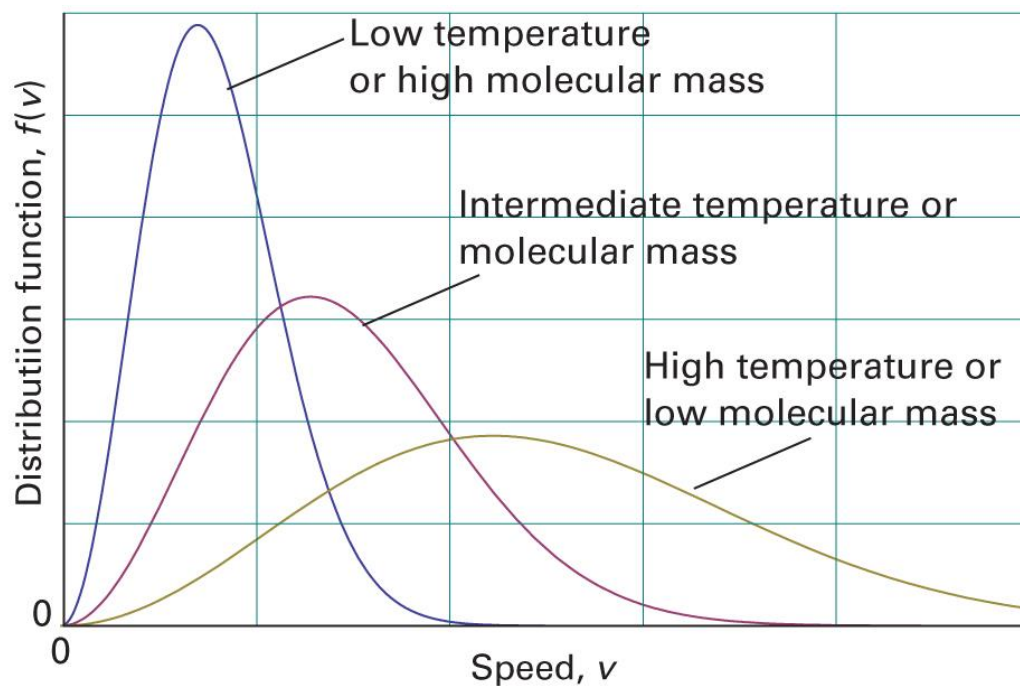
$$f(v) = 4\pi \left(\frac{m}{2\pi k_B T} \right)^{3/2} v^2 e^{-mv^2/2k_B T}$$

$$f(v) = 4\pi \left(\frac{M}{2\pi R T} \right)^{3/2} v^2 e^{-Mv^2/2RT}$$

$R = k_B N_A$
 $M = m N_A$

Interpretations

$$f(v) = 4\pi \left(\frac{M}{2\pi RT} \right)^{3/2} v^2 e^{-Mv^2/2RT}$$



(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 12th ed., Figure 1B.4)

Characteristic Speeds

1. Mean speed $\langle v \rangle = v_{\text{mean}}$

$$\langle v \rangle = \int_0^{\infty} v f(v) dv$$

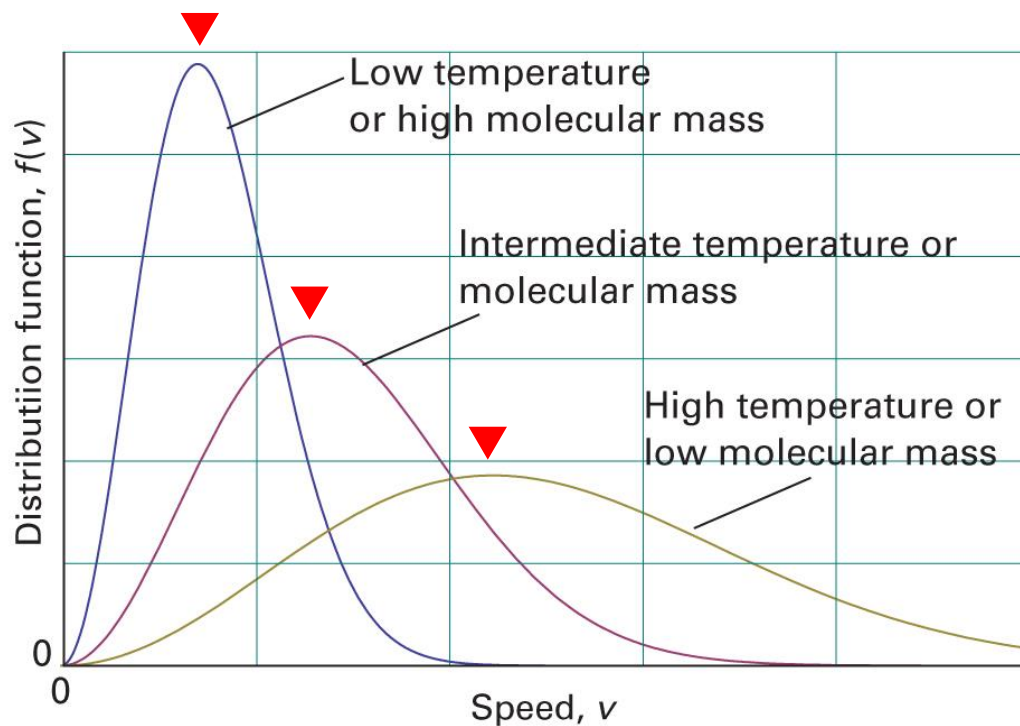
2. Root-mean-square speed v_{rms}

$$v_{\text{rms}} = \sqrt{\langle v^2 \rangle}$$

$$\langle v^2 \rangle = \int_0^{\infty} v^2 f(v) dv$$

Characteristic Speeds

3. Most probable speed v_{mp}



$$\frac{df(v)}{dv} = 0$$

(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 12th ed., Figure 1B.4)

Characteristic Speeds: KMT

1. Mean speed

$$\langle v \rangle = \left(\frac{8RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2}$$

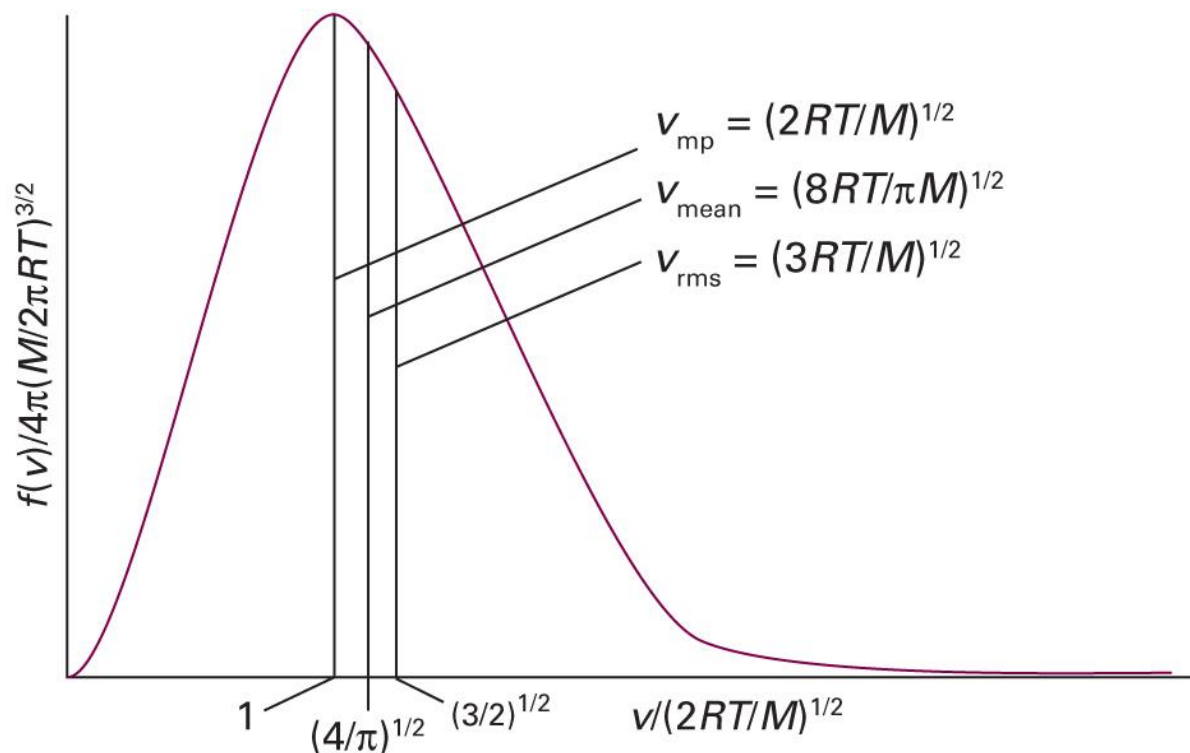
2. Root-mean-square speed

$$v_{\text{rms}} = \left(\frac{3RT}{M} \right)^{1/2}$$

3. Most probable speed

$$v_{\text{mp}} = \left(\frac{2RT}{M} \right)^{1/2}$$

Characteristic Speeds: KMT



(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 12th ed., Figure 1B.6)

Example 1B.1

Calculate v_{rms} and the mean speed, $\langle v \rangle$, of N_2 molecules at 25°C .

For N_2 , $M = 28.02 \text{ g mol}^{-1} = 0.02802 \text{ kg mol}^{-1}$

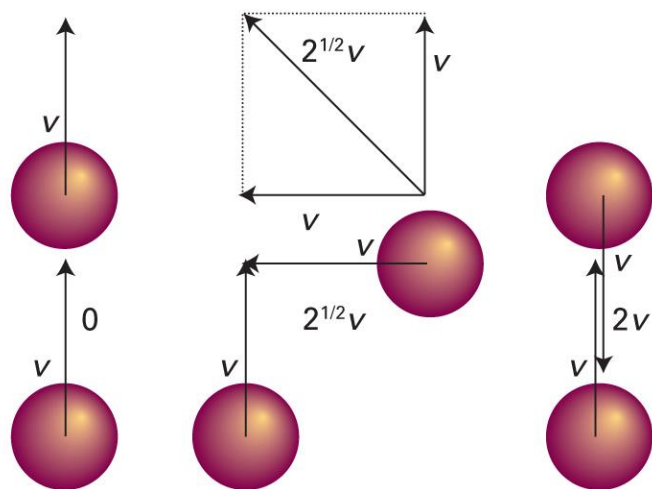
$T = (273 + 25) \text{ K} = 298 \text{ K}$

$$v_{\text{rms}} = \left(\frac{3RT}{M} \right)^{1/2} = \left\{ \frac{3 \times (8.3145 \text{ J K}^{-1} \text{ mol}^{-1}) \times (298 \text{ K})}{0.02802 \text{ kg mol}^{-1}} \right\}^{1/2} = 515 \text{ m s}^{-1}$$

$$\langle v \rangle = \left(\frac{8RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2} = \left\{ \frac{8 \times (8.3145 \text{ J K}^{-1} \text{ mol}^{-1}) \times (298 \text{ K})}{3.1416 \times 0.02802 \text{ kg mol}^{-1}} \right\}^{1/2} = 475 \text{ m s}^{-1}$$

Mean Relative Speed

“Mean speed with which a molecule approaches another”



$$v_{\text{rel}} = 2^{1/2} \langle v \rangle = \left(\frac{16RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2}$$

(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 12th ed., Figure 1B.7)

Mean Relative Speed

For two molecules of different types (A and B),

$$v_{\text{rel}} = \left(\frac{8k_{\text{B}}T}{\pi\mu} \right)^{1/2}$$

where reduced mass $\mu = m_{\text{A}}m_{\text{B}}/(m_{\text{A}} + m_{\text{B}})$

If $m_{\text{A}} = m_{\text{B}}$,

$$\mu = m_{\text{A}}^2/(2m_{\text{A}}) = m_{\text{A}}/2$$

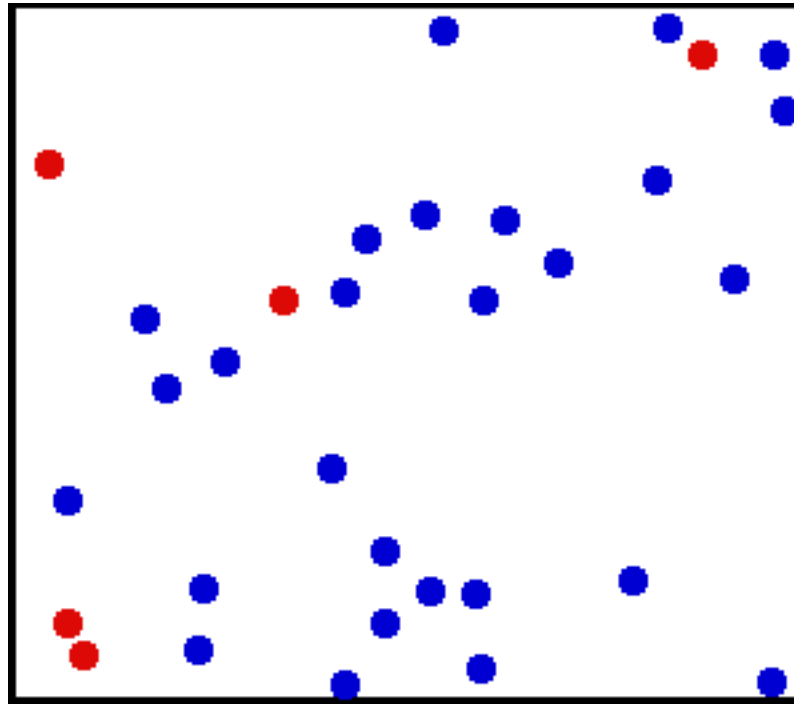
$$v_{\text{rel}} = \left(\frac{16k_{\text{B}}T}{\pi m} \right)^{1/2} = \left(\frac{16RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2}$$

Brief Illustration 1B.1(a)

The mean speed of N_2 molecules at 25°C is 475 m s^{-1} . What is their relative mean speed?

$$v_{\text{rel}} = 2^{1/2} \langle v \rangle = \sqrt{2} \times (475\text{ m s}^{-1}) = 671\text{ m s}^{-1}$$

Application: Collisions



(Image: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Translational_motion.gif)

Consequences of Collisions

- Molecule-molecule collisions

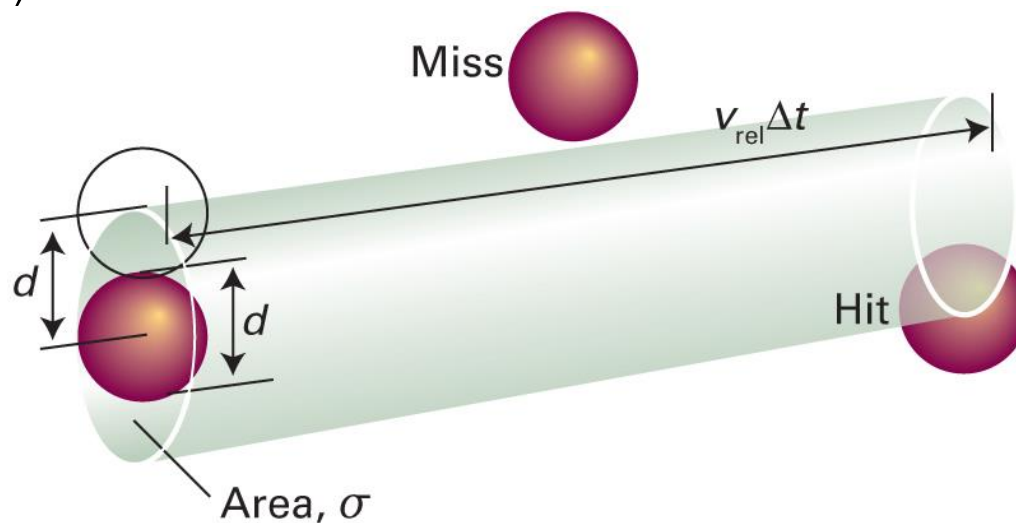
Molecular origin of chemical reactions

- Molecule-wall collisions

Molecular origin of pressure

Molecule-Molecule Collisions

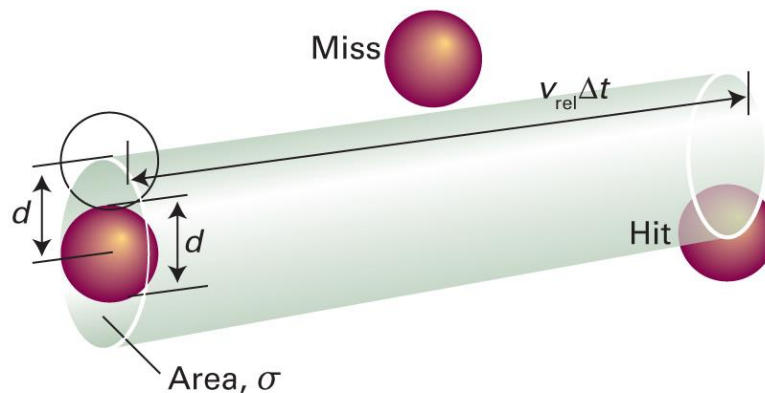
For time Δt ,



d = collision diameter

$\sigma = \pi d^2$ = cross-sectional area

Collision Frequency



- Volume of the collision tube = $\sigma \times v_{\text{rel}} \Delta t$
- Number of molecules in the tube = volume $\times$ density

$$= (\sigma v_{\text{rel}} \Delta t) \times (nN_A/V)$$
- Collision frequency $z = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} nN_A/V$

p -dependences of z

$$z = \frac{\sigma v_{\text{rel}} n N_A}{V} = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_A \frac{n}{V}$$

For constant T , $v_{\text{rel}} = (16RT/\pi M)^{1/2}$ is also constant.

Since $pV = nRT$,

$$z = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_A \frac{p}{RT} = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} \frac{p}{k_B T} \propto p \text{ (at constant } T\text{)}$$

Brief Illustration 1B.1(b)

What is the collision frequency of an N_2 molecule in a sample at 1.00 atm and 25 °C? ($\sigma = 0.43 \text{ nm}^2$)

From Brief Illustration 1B.1, $v_{\text{rel}} = 671 \text{ m s}^{-1}$.

$$z = \frac{\sigma v_{\text{rel}} p}{k_{\text{B}} T} = \frac{(0.43 \times 10^{-18} \text{ m}^2) \times (671 \text{ m s}^{-1}) \times (1.01 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa})}{(1.381 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J K}^{-1}) \times (298 \text{ K})}$$
$$z = 7.1 \times 10^9 \text{ s}^{-1}$$

T*-dependences of *z

$$z = \frac{\sigma v_{\text{rel}} n N_{\text{A}}}{V} = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_{\text{A}} \frac{n}{V}$$

Since $v_{\text{rel}} = (16RT/\pi M)^{1/2}$,

$$z = \sigma N_{\text{A}} \frac{n}{V} \left(\frac{16RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2} \propto \sqrt{T} \text{ (at constant } V\text{)}$$

Since $pV = nRT$,

$$z = \sigma N_{\text{A}} \frac{p}{RT} \left(\frac{16RT}{\pi M} \right)^{1/2} \propto \frac{1}{\sqrt{T}} \text{ (at constant } p\text{)}$$

Mean Free Path, λ

“Average distance a molecule travels between collisions”

$$\lambda = \text{speed} \times \text{time} = v_{\text{rel}} \times (1/z) = v_{\text{rel}}/z$$

Hence,

$$\lambda = \frac{k_B T}{\sigma p}$$

Brief Illustration 1B.2

What is the mean free path of an N_2 molecule in a sample at 1.00 atm and 25 °C?

From Brief Illustration 1B.1(a), $v_{\text{rel}} = 671 \text{ m s}^{-1}$.

From Brief Illustration 1B.1(b), $z = 7.1 \times 10^9 \text{ s}^{-1}$.

$$\lambda = \frac{v_{\text{rel}}}{z} = \frac{671 \text{ m s}^{-1}}{7.1 \times 10^9 \text{ s}^{-1}} = 9.5 \times 10^{-8} \text{ m}$$

Prelude to Chemical Kinetics

$$z = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_A \frac{n}{V}$$

Suppose that we have two types of molecules, A and B.

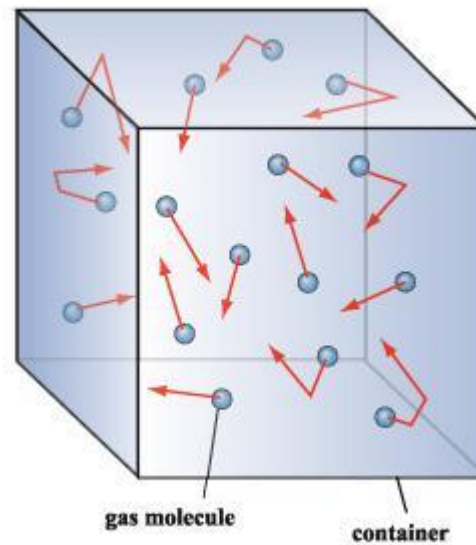
The collision rate of one A molecule with B molecules is

$$z = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_A \frac{n_B}{V}$$

Hence, the collision density $Z_{AB} = z(N_A n_A / V)$

$$Z_{AB} = \sigma v_{\text{rel}} N_A^2 \frac{n_A}{V} \frac{n_B}{V} = \sigma \left(\frac{8k_B T}{\pi \mu} \right)^{1/2} N_A^2 [A][B] \propto [A][B]$$

Molecular Origin of Pressure



Position and Velocity

Each particle with mass m has its own

- Position $\vec{r} = (x, y, z)$
- Velocity $\vec{v} = (v_x, v_y, v_z)$

$$\vec{v} = \frac{d\vec{r}}{dt} = \left(\frac{dx}{dt}, \frac{dy}{dt}, \frac{dz}{dt} \right)$$

We can define linear momentum $\vec{p} = m\vec{v}$

Review

Newton's Second Law of Motion

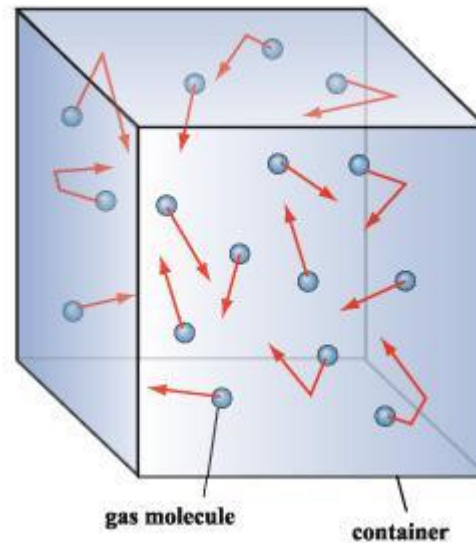
$$\text{Acceleration } \vec{a} = \frac{d\vec{v}}{dt}$$

Acceleration is determined by the force $\vec{F}$

$$\vec{F} = m\vec{a} = m \frac{d\vec{v}}{dt} = \frac{d\vec{p}}{dt}$$

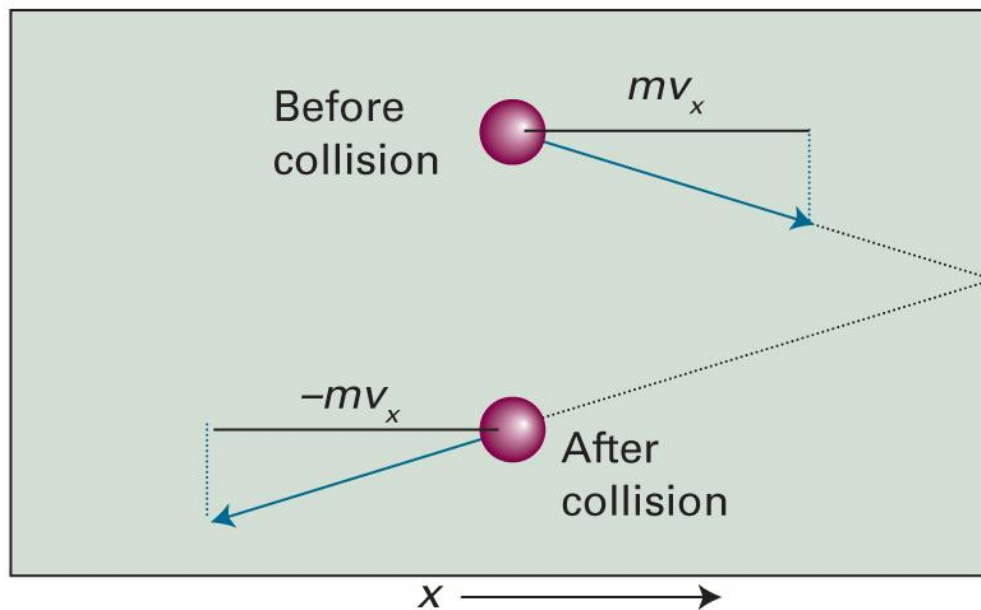
If $\vec{F} = 0$, $\frac{d\vec{p}}{dt} = 0$ (momentum conservation)

Derivation of Pressure



- Pressure $p = F/A$
- Force $\vec{F} = d\vec{p}/dt$: from collisions against the wall

The Change in Momentum



Change in momentum: $mv_x \rightarrow -mv_x$

$$\Delta p_{\text{particle}} = -mv_x - mv_x = -2mv_x$$

Momentum Change of the Wall

- The particle has the momentum change of

$$\Delta p_{\text{particle}} = -mv_x - mv_x = -2mv_x$$

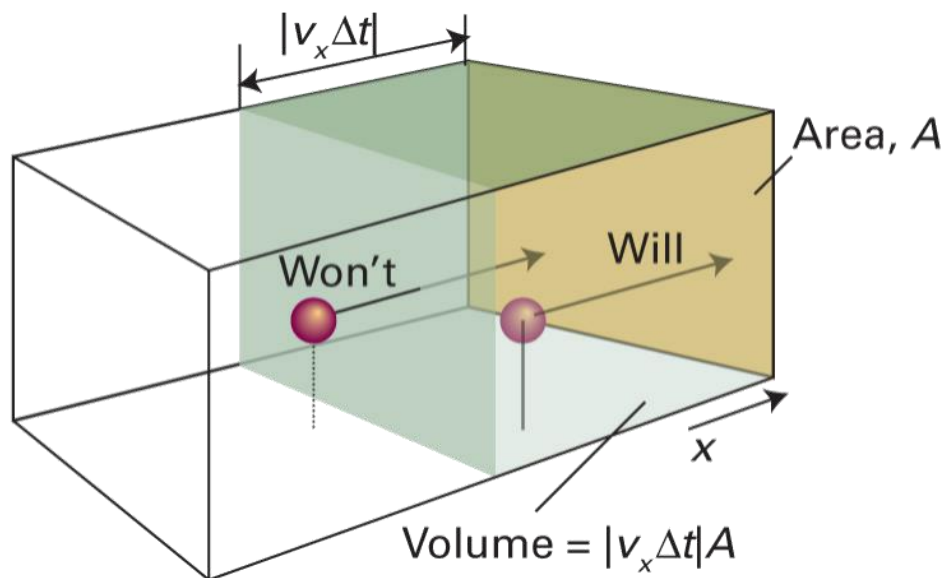
- The wall has the momentum change of

$$\Delta p_{\text{wall}} = 2mv_x$$

How Many Molecules Collide

Assume that all molecules have the same velocity.

For time Δt ,



Number of molecules = volume $\times$ density

$$= (A v_x \Delta t) \times (N_A n / V)$$

(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 12th ed., Figure 1B.2)

Total Momentum Change

- For each molecule colliding the wall, the wall obtains

$$\Delta p_{\text{wall}} = 2mv_x$$

- Number of molecules = $(Av_x\Delta t) \times (N_A n/V)$
- 50% moving to the right, 50% to the left
- Total momentum change

$$\Delta p_{\text{wall, total}} = (2mv_x) \times (Av_x\Delta t) \left(\frac{N_A n}{V} \right) \times \frac{1}{2} = \frac{\overbrace{nmN_A}^M Av_x^2 \Delta t}{V}$$

Force and Pressure

- Total momentum change $\Delta p_{\text{wall,total}} = nMAv_x^2 \Delta t / V$
- Force exerted on the wall

$$F = \frac{\Delta p_{\text{wall,total}}}{\Delta t} = \frac{nMAv_x^2}{V}$$

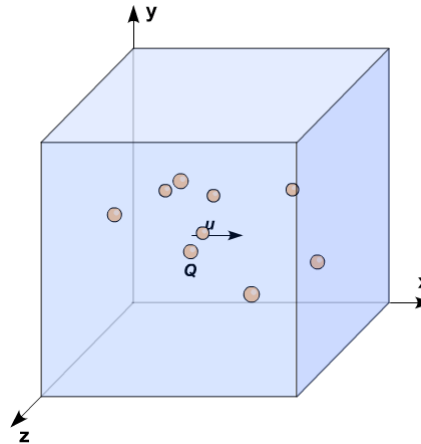
- Pressure exerted on the wall

$$p = \frac{F}{A} = \frac{nMv_x^2}{V}$$

(under the same velocity assumption)

Same Velocity Assumption

- In reality, each particle has a different velocity



- Replace the value by the mean value:

$$v_x^2 \rightarrow \langle v_x^2 \rangle$$

Pressure

$$p = \frac{nMv_x^2}{V} \rightarrow p = \frac{nM\langle v_x^2 \rangle}{V}$$

- Total velocity $v^2 = v_x^2 + v_y^2 + v_z^2$

$$\begin{aligned}\langle v^2 \rangle &= \langle v_x^2 \rangle + \langle v_y^2 \rangle + \langle v_z^2 \rangle \\ &= \langle v_x^2 \rangle + \langle v_x^2 \rangle + \langle v_x^2 \rangle = 3\langle v_x^2 \rangle\end{aligned}$$

- Final formula

$$p = \frac{nM\langle v^2 \rangle}{3V}$$

p - T Relationship

$$pV = \frac{1}{3} nM \langle v^2 \rangle$$

From the Maxwell-Boltzmann distribution,

$$\langle v^2 \rangle = v_{\text{rms}}^2 = \frac{3RT}{M}$$

Hence,

$$pV = nRT$$